

Annual Review — Postdoctoral Fellow

Dempsey Lab · University of Michigan

Complete Parts 1–6 before our review meeting; Part 7 is finalized together. The organizing question of a postdoc review is trajectory toward independence: your own research line, your own funding, your own students. Focus on what was learned, not what was worked on.

Name: Postdoc start date:

Review period: Funding source:

Mentor: Walter Dempsey Date of review:

Part 1 · Last Year's Goals — Accountability Loop

Copy each goal from last year's review and record its outcome. First-year postdocs: skip to Part 2.

Goal 1:

Outcome: Achieved Partially achieved Dropped / pivoted

Goal 2:

Outcome: Achieved Partially achieved Dropped / pivoted

Goal 3:

Outcome: Achieved Partially achieved Dropped / pivoted

Part 2 · Research Program & Independence

Research progress this year: key results, methods developed, applications.

State findings, not activity.

Your independent research line: what direction is distinctly yours, beyond ongoing lab projects? How did it advance this year?

Part 3 · Funding & Fellowships

Applications submitted or planned (K99/R00, F32, foundation awards, internal pilots), with status and dates.

Contributions to lab grant writing (aims pages, preliminary data, budgets).

Part 4 · Mentoring & Lab Leadership

Students mentored and projects overseen; what did your mentees accomplish?

Mentoring track record matters for faculty applications — be concrete.

Contributions to lab infrastructure, onboarding, or shared resources.

Part 5 · Career & Job Market

Target track: Tenure-track (research) Teaching-focused Industry research
 Government / nonprofit Undecided

Planned market cycle (e.g., Fall 2027):

Applications target:

Materials status: Research statement Teaching statement Job talk CV current
 References lined up

Check items that are drafted or better.

Visibility this year: invited talks, conference presentations, networking, reviewing/editorial work.

Part 6 · Support Needed

What do you need from me?

Introductions, letter timelines, practice-talk audiences, protected time for your own line, grant mentorship.

Part 7 · Goals for the Coming Year (finalized together at the meeting)

Goal 1:

Deliverable: Target date:

Goal 2:

Deliverable: Target date:

Goal 3:

Deliverable: Target date:

Appointment / renewal plan:

Mentor Assessment

Progress vs. timeline: Ahead On track Needs improvement — plan below

Independence trajectory: Ahead of schedule On schedule Needs acceleration

Strengths observed this year.

Growth areas and agreed actions (with checkpoints).

Postdoc signature

Date:

Mentor signature

Date: